Frontend Branch Pre-Merge Review

Nov 7, 2026 · @Sajawal

Summary

Verdict: not ready to merge. Signup is broken, Forgot Password is unreachable, Lecture Slides crashes on load, and login accepts any password. There is no backend connection at all, even though the latest commit is titled "Integration done".

Item	State
Branch	`frontend`, 6 commits ahead of `main` (merge base `74f348b`)
Behind `main`	6 commits (the whole backend: #27, #28, #30, #26, #33, #34)
Diff	38 files added, +7,064 lines, 0 lines touched outside `frontend/` and `web project frontend/`
Git merge	No textual conflicts (`git merge-tree` is clean)
Backend calls from the frontend	0 (`fetch` / XHR appear nowhere)
Tests	None for the frontend

How I checked: read every HTML and JS file, and loaded all 9 pages in headless Chromium to record JS errors, redirects and form behaviour. No files were changed.

Critical (blocking)

Each of these breaks a core flow or is a security hole. All were reproduced in a browser.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
C1	Signup page is completely broken	`frontend/html/signup.html:55`	Loads only `auth.js`; never loads `common.js` or `signup.js`. Clicking Sign Up throws `ReferenceError: signup is not defined`. `auth.js` also uses `NUML`, which does not exist on this page. No one can create an account.	Replace the script tag with `<script src="../js/common.js"></script>` then `<script src="../js/signup.js"></script>`. Remove `auth.js` from this page. Re-test: valid form should redirect to login, invalid shows the message.
C2	Login accepts any password	`frontend/js/auth.js:15-43`	Any `@numls.edu.pk` email plus any 8+ character string logs in. Tested `anyone@numls.edu.pk` / `12345678` and reached the dashboard. No credential is checked anywhere.	Delete the local `setUser` logic. `POST /api/auth/login` with `{identifier, password}`; on 200 save the returned token and user; on 401 show "Invalid roll number or password". Never decide login in the browser.
C3	Auth is a client-side flag, so every page guard is bypassable	`frontend/js/common.js:76-104`	"Logged in" means `localStorage.numlUser` has a `name`. Typing `localStorage.numlUser='{"name":"x"}'` in the console grants access. There is no token, no expiry, no server check.	Store the JWT, not a user object. Add `NUML.api(path, opts)` that sets `Authorization: Bearer <token>` and, on 401, clears the token and goes to login. `requireLogin()` calls `GET /api/auth/me`; real protection is the backend rejecting requests without a valid token.
C4	Zero backend integration despite the "Integration done" commit	all of `frontend/js/`	No `fetch` or XHR exists. Signup has a `TODO (backend)` comment. Papers, lectures and uploads are hardcoded arrays. Merging this as "integrated" misstates the project's state.	Either do the integration (C2, C3, C7, M5, M8), or title the PR "Frontend UI (mock data, no backend)" and list what is mocked in the description. Add one `API_BASE` constant in `common.js` so integration later is a single switch.
C5	Forgot Password page is unreachable	`common.js:22-30` vs `forgetpassword.html`	`PUBLIC_PAGES` lists `forgot.html` and `forgot-password.html`; the real file is `forgetpassword.html`. The guard treats it as protected and redirects logged-out users to login, the only users who need it. Confirmed: opening it lands on `login.html`.	Rename the file to `forgot-password.html`, set `PAGES.forgot = "forgot-password.html"`, keep `PUBLIC_PAGES` built only from `PAGES` (no string literals), and update the link in `login.html`.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
C6	Lecture Slides page crashes on load	`frontend/html/lecture.html`	It is a copy of the Past Papers page: title says "Past Papers", and it loads `pastpaper.js` instead of `lecture.js`. Result: `TypeError: Cannot read properties of null (reading 'addEventListener')`. `lecture.js` (209 lines) is never loaded by any page, and its element ids (`fTitle`, `fSubject`) are not in the HTML.	Rebuild `lecture.html` for lectures: title "Lecture Slides", filters with ids `fTitle`, `fSubject`, `fYear`, the upload form ids `lecture.js` uses, and load `common.js` + `lecture.js`. Then open it and confirm the console is clean.
C7	Contract mismatch with the backend on `main`	`signup.js`, `auth.js` vs `backend/app/routers/auth.py`	Frontend sends an email; backend `register` / `login` take `identifier` = roll number and the register check rejects emails. The frontend also has no concept of `activate` or roles (student, teacher, hod, admin) or a JWT. Wiring it up later means rewriting both auth files.	Agree one contract with the backend owner first (write it in `docs/`). Change the forms to ask for roll number, send `identifier`, add an Activate Account page for `/api/auth/activate`, and route by the `role` the API returns.

Major

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
M1	Most protected pages have no login guard	`pastpapers.html`, `lecture.html`, `gpacal.html`, `tools-resources.html`	None of them loads `common.js`, so the guard and shared nav never run. Logged-out users open them directly.	Add `<script src="../js/common.js"></script>` before the page script on every page. Test logged out: each should redirect to login.
M2	`common.js` page map does not match real filenames	`common.js:19-28`	`forgot.html` (real: `forgetpassword.html`), `pastpaper.html` (real: `pastpapers.html`), `resources.html` (real: `tools-resources.html`). Every nav or quick link built from `PAGES` is a 404.	Pick one naming style (lowercase, hyphens) and make `PAGES` match the files exactly. Then replace hardcoded `href="...html"` in pages with the same names. A one-line check: `ls frontend/html` vs the `PAGES` values.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
M3	Broken links to pages that don't exist	`dashboard.html`, `tools-resources.html`	Dashboard "Uni Lecs" links to `unilecs.html` (file is `lecture.html`). Resources nav links to `timetable.html` and `archive.html`; neither exists.	Point "Uni Lecs" to `lecture.html`. Remove the Timetable and Archive links until those pages exist (or link to a "coming soon" page). Run a dead-link check before every merge.
M4	Entire duplicate folder `web project frontend/`	repo root	12 files, about 2,360 lines, are older copies of files in `frontend/` (`resources.js` and `dashboard.css` are byte-identical). The folder has a space in its name and a typo'd `hmtl/` subfolder. Two sources of truth means people will edit the wrong one. Delete before merge.	First diff it against `frontend/` and copy over anything newer (only `dashboard.js` and some HTML differ). Then `git rm -r "web project frontend"`. Git history keeps the old copy.
M5	Uploads are fake and vanish	`pastpaper.js:565`, `lecture.js:187`	Uploaded files become `URL.createObjectURL` blobs held in memory. They disappear on reload and nobody else sees them, yet the UI says "Your paper will appear after it is reviewed". There is no review step.	Send files with `FormData` to the backend `exams` / `materials` upload endpoints, list from their GET endpoints, and show status "pending" until approved. Until the API is ready, hide the upload button or label it "demo only".
M6	Lecture data points at files that don't exist	`lecture.js` sample records	`../lectures/dsa-trees.pdf` etc. There is no `frontend/lectures/` folder; every link 404s.	Remove the sample records and load lectures from the `materials` API. If you need demo data, add real small PDFs or use a clearly marked mock JSON file.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
M7	Scope drift from the repo's purpose	`index.html`, overall	Repo and backend are **timetable automation** (timetable, rooms, swaps, makeup classes, notifications). The frontend is a "NUML Archive" for past papers, lectures and software links. The landing page advertises Timetable and Free Rooms, but no page implements them. Agree with the team whether this belongs in this repo before merging.	Hold a 15-minute team decision, write it in the README. If kept: add Timetable and Free Rooms pages against the `timetable` and `rooms` APIs, since that is the core. If not: move the archive UI to its own repo.
M8	Duplicate subject catalogue hardcoded in two files	`lecture.js:3`, `pastpaper.js:14`	Two diverging copies of the course list (the backend also has a `course` model). Any change must be made 3 times. Should come from the API.	Short term: move the list into one `js/data/subjects.js` loaded by both pages. Long term: fetch it from a backend courses endpoint and delete the hardcoded list.

Moderate

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
D1	Profiles store personal data in localStorage	`common.js:87-93`	Name, email, department and system id for every account created on that browser stay in `numlProfiles` forever. On a shared lab PC, the next user can read them. Logout doesn't clear them.	Delete `saveProfile` / `findProfile` and the `numlProfiles` key. Get the profile from `GET /api/auth/me` after login. Logout clears the token only.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
D2	No shared layout; every page has its own header	all HTML	Dashboard has a sidebar, Resources and GPA a top navbar, Past Papers a banner, others the `common.js` injected nav. Navigation differs on each page.	Choose one layout (the dashboard sidebar is the most complete). Render it from `common.js` on every protected page and remove each page's own header markup.
D3	Nav styles injected as an inline `<style>` from JS	`common.js:110-131`	Hardcoded colours outside the CSS files, applied after first paint (flash of unstyled nav). Belongs in `master.css`.	Move the `.numl-nav` and `.numl-quick` rules into `master.css`, use its colour variables, and delete `injectStyles()`.
D4	Four unused CSS files	`frontend/css/dashboard.css`, `resources.css`, `signup.css`, `gpacal.css`	No HTML links them; pages use `app.css` (1,166 lines) instead. Dead code that will be edited by mistake.	`git rm` the four files. Optionally split `app.css` per page later, but only one copy of each rule.
D5	`innerHTML` with template values	`gpacal.js:34`	`value="${name}"` is interpolated raw. Safe today (only default values), but becomes an XSS / broken-markup bug once rows are restored from storage or the API. Use DOM calls like `common.js` does.	Build the row with `document.createElement`, and set `input.value = name` and `option.textContent`. Or use a `<template>` element and clone it.
D6	Password rule shown wrong	`signup.html` placeholder	Says "At least 6 characters"; the rule (and backend) is 8.	Change to "At least 8 characters" and add `minlength="8"` on both password inputs.
D7	Inline `onsubmit=` handlers depend on globals	`login.html`, `signup.html`, `forgetpassword.html`	Ties markup to global function names, which is exactly why C1 fails silently. Prefer `addEventListener` in the script.	Remove `onsubmit` attributes. In each script: `document.getElementById("loginForm").addEventListener("submit", login)`. A missing form then fails loudly in the console.
D8	Forgot Password does nothing	`auth.js:46-60`	Shows "reset link has been sent" without sending anything. Fine as a placeholder only if labelled as such.	The backend has no reset endpoint yet. Either ask for one, or change the message to "Contact your department admin to reset your password" until it exists.

#	Issue	Where	Evidence / impact	How to fix
D9	Fonts from Google on some pages only	`dashboard.html`, `index.html`	Poppins on one, Plus Jakarta Sans on another, system fonts elsewhere. Inconsistent look; external request on a student portal.	Pick one font, set it once in `master.css` (`font-family` on `body`), self-host it in `frontend/fonts/` or use the system font stack, and remove the per-page `<link>` tags.

Minor

- **Filename typo:** `forgetpassword.html` should be `forgot-password.html` (and match `PAGES`).
  - Fix: covered by C5; rename with `git mv` so history follows the file.
- **Wrong comment:** `common.js:10` says load with `defer`; no page does. Either use `defer` everywhere or fix the comment.
  - Fix: add `defer` to every script tag (order is kept), then the comment is true.
- **Leftover dead code:** `dashboard.js:31` has an empty "Optional: only runs if common.js defines it" block; `renderQuickLinks()` is exported but never called.
  - Fix: delete the empty block; either call `NUML.renderQuickLinks()` on the dashboard or remove the function.
- **Duplicate logout redirect:** `dashboard.js` checks the session itself even though `common.js` already does. One guard is enough.
  - Fix: remove the `if (!user)` redirect from `dashboard.js`; keep the one in `common.js`.
- **Commit hygiene:** the branch has a merge commit and a commit whose message is only `Co-authored-by: Taha ...`. Squash-merge, or rewrite messages before merging.
  - Fix: use "Squash and merge" on the PR with one clear message; in future, `git pull --rebase` instead of merge pulls.
- **Hardcoded year range:** `lecture.js` fills years back to 2000; the university's catalogue doesn't need 26 years of options.
  - Fix: set a `FIRST_YEAR` constant (for example 2018), or build the list from years present in the data.
- **Accessibility:** profile menu toggle has no keyboard Escape close; emoji icons on `index.html` have no `aria-hidden`; form errors are not tied to inputs with `aria-describedby`.

  - Fix: add a `keydown` handler closing the menu on `Escape`; wrap emoji in `<span aria-hidden="true">`; give each input `aria-describedby` pointing at its hint/error and `role="alert"` on `#msg`.
- **Large image:** `numl.webp` is 61 KB and used as a background in two CSS files; fine, but no `preload` so the hero renders blank first.
  - Fix: add `<link rel="preload" as="image" href="../images/numl.webp">` on the pages that use it, and a background colour fallback.
- **No README** for the frontend: how to run it (it is opened as `file://` today), what is mocked, and what the API base URL will be.
  - Fix: add `frontend/README.md` with run steps (for example `python -m http.server` in `frontend/`), the page list, what is mocked, and `API_BASE`.
- **No linting or formatting config** (ESLint / Prettier). Indentation and quote style vary between files.
  - Fix: add `.eslintrc` and `.prettierrc` at the repo root, run Prettier once over `frontend/` in its own commit, and add it to CI later.
- **Insecure link:** MARS link in `resources.js:521` uses `http://`; switch to HTTPS or a maintained mirror.
  - Fix: use the HTTPS version if the site supports it; otherwise link the GitHub release page of a maintained MARS fork.

Recommended fix order

Merge only after steps 1 to 5 pass; steps 6 to 8 can follow in separate PRs.

1. Decide scope (M7): is "NUML Archive" part of this timetable project? If not, it belongs in its own repo.
2. Delete `web project frontend/` (M4) and the 4 unused CSS files (D4).
3. Fix filenames and `PAGES` so every link resolves (C5, M2, M3), and load `common.js` on every page (M1).
4. Fix the broken pages: signup scripts (C1) and a real `lecture.html` that loads `lecture.js` (C6).
5. Rename the "Integration done" commit or the PR title so it doesn't claim integration (C4).

6. Integrate auth against `/api/auth/*`: roll number as identifier, `activate` flow, JWT stored and sent, `/me` on refresh (C2, C3, C7). Note that `backend/app/main.py` on `main` is currently 0 bytes, so the API can't run yet either; that needs fixing on the backend side first.
7. Replace hardcoded papers, lectures and subjects with API calls, and real uploads (M5, M6, M8).
8. Clean up moderate and minor items, add a README and a linter.

One honest caveat on my own ranking: if the team agrees this branch is a UI prototype only, C2 to C4 and C7 become "known limitations" rather than blockers. In that case, label it clearly as a mock in the README and PR, but C1, C5, C6, M1 to M4 still block, because they are plain bugs.